



Computational and Deep Learning Strategies in Quantitative Finance for Robust Hedging under Market Frictions

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1. Introduction & Motivation

Pricing and hedging of portfolios of derivatives is central to **risk management** in financial institutions and industry. Traditional Black-Scholes delta hedging assumes **continuous trading, zero costs, and complete markets** — assumptions that fail in practice. Deep hedging framework reformulates this as stochastic optimal control via **neural networks**, incorporating real market frictions.

Three Fundamental Gaps

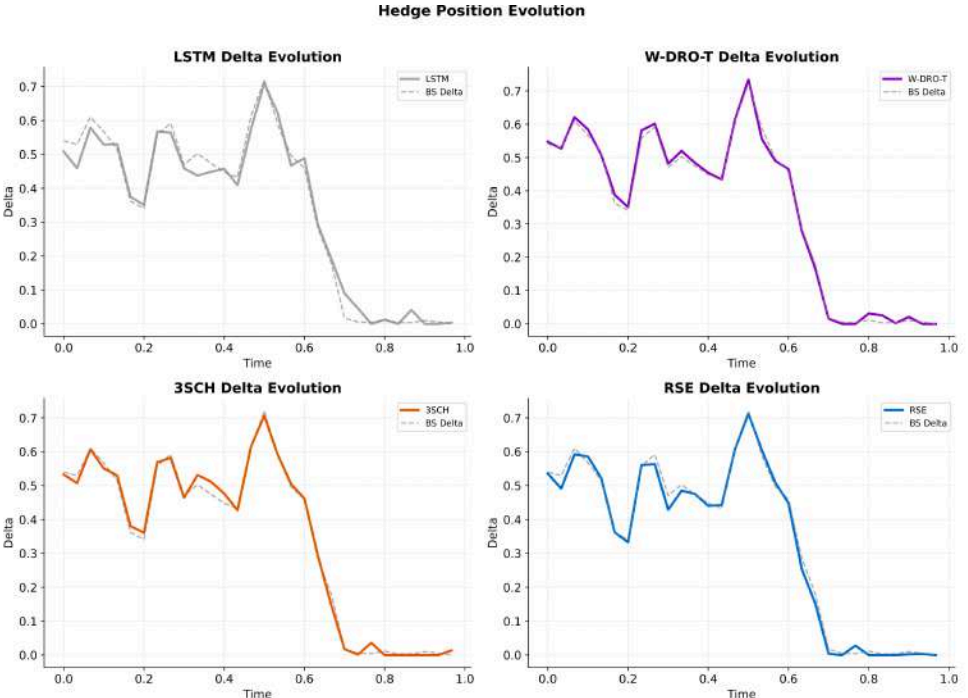
- **Model Uncertainty** — Fixed Heston parameters degrade under **distributional shift** (CVar₉₅ degradation >4× during crises)
- **Training Instability** — Two-stage CVar → Entropic protocol causes **abrupt objective transitions**
- **Regime Dependence** — Different **architectures excel in different market condition**

Three Novel Solutions

- **W-DRO-T** — Wasserstein DRO regularisation for **distributional robustness**
- **3SCH** — Mixed-loss objective for **smooth training transitions**
- **RSE** — Regime-dependent gating over **diverse base hedgers**

Market Frictions in Real-World Financial Markets

- SPY: ~3 bps all-in transaction costs
- NIFTY: ~18 bps (STT 0.05%, stamp duty, wider spreads and SEBI position limits)
- Daily rebalancing: N=30 steps for 30-day options
- Position limits: Regulatory and risk constraints restrict allowable hedge ratios and exposures.



2. Background & Literature Review

Classical Hedging

Black-Scholes delta: $\delta^1 = \Phi(d_1)$, assumes GBM, continuous trading, zero costs. Under Heston stochastic volatility, **markets are incomplete** — perfect replication is impossible.

Deep Hedging (Buehler et al., 2019)

Neural-network-parametrised hedging under **convex risk measures**. Learned policies outperform BS delta hedging with transaction costs. **Two-stage curriculum**: CVar pre-training → entropic fine-tuning.

Universal Approximation in Neural Networks

Universal Approximation theorem by neural networks enables to **approximate multivariate functions** arbitrarily well.

3. Mathematical Framework & Setting

Heston Stochastic Volatility Market Model

We work on $(\Omega, \mathcal{F}, (\mathcal{F}_t)_{t \in [0, T]}, \mathbb{P})$ supporting a two-dimensional Brownian motion (W^S, W^V) with $\langle W^S, W^V \rangle_t = \rho dt$, $\rho \in (-1, 0)$. The Heston model:

$$dS_t = rS_t dt + \sqrt{v_t} S_t dW_t^S, \quad S_0 > 0, \quad (1)$$

$$dv_t = \kappa(\theta_v - v_t) dt + \xi \sqrt{v_t} dW_t^V, \quad v_0 > 0. \quad (2)$$

Remark 1 (Feller Condition). The variance process remains strictly positive when $2\kappa\theta_v > \xi^2$. Our calibration: $2 \times 1.0 \times 0.04 = 0.08 > 0.04 = \xi^2$.

Discretisation

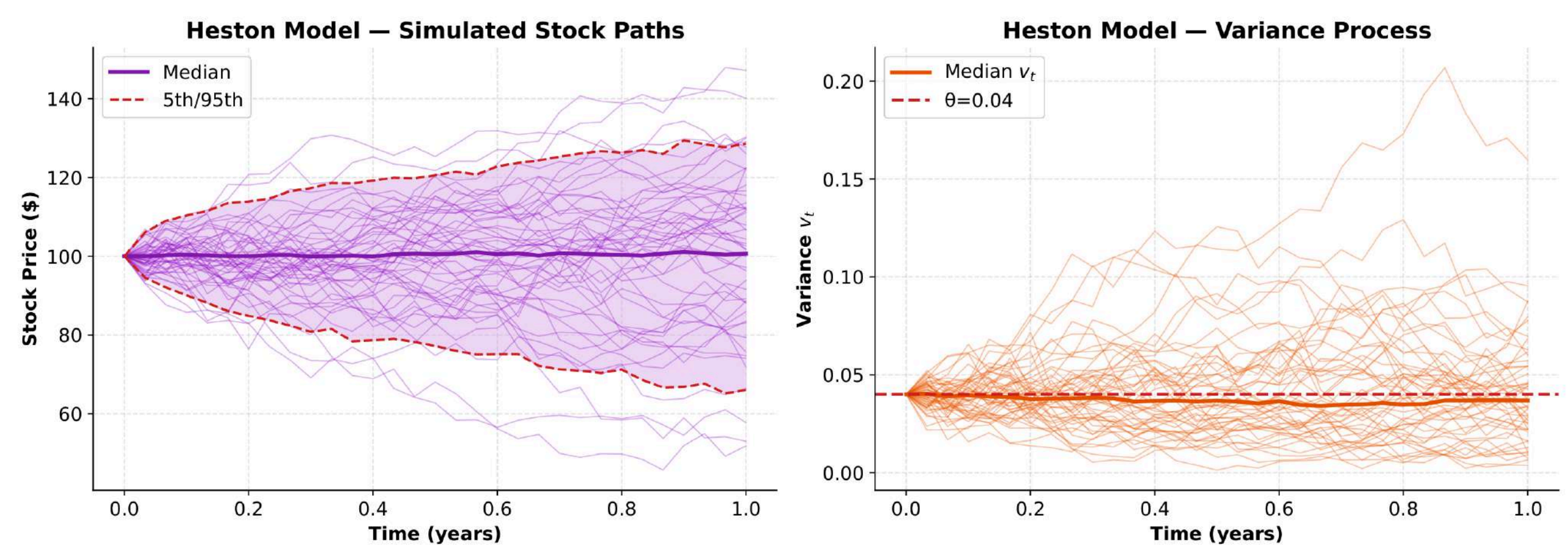
Euler-Maruyama Scheme

Full-truncation scheme on equidistant grid $\Delta t = T/N$:

$$S_{k+1} = S_k \exp\left((r - \frac{1}{2}v_k^*)\Delta t + \sqrt{v_k^*}\Delta t \epsilon_k^S\right),$$

$$v_{k+1} = v_k + \kappa(\theta_v - v_k)\Delta t + \xi\sqrt{v_k^*}\Delta t \epsilon_k^V,$$

where $v_k^* = \max(v_k, 0)$ and $(\epsilon_k^S, \epsilon_k^V) \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \Sigma)$ with $\Sigma_{12} = \rho$.



Hedging P&L

For European call payoff $Z = (S_T - K)^+$ with $N = 30$ hedging steps:

$$P\&L(\delta) = -Z + \sum_{k=0}^{N-1} \delta_k (S_{k+1} - S_k) - c_0 \sum_{k=0}^{N-1} |\delta_k - \delta_{k-1}| S_k$$

with $c_0 = 0.001$ and $\delta_{-1} = \delta_N = 0$ (flat entry/exit).

Risk Measures

Conditional Value at Risk

Definition 1 (CVar _{α}). Let $L = -P\&L$ and $\alpha \in (0, 1)$.

$$\text{CVar}_\alpha(L) = \inf\{l \in \mathbb{R} : \mathbb{P}(L \leq l) \geq \alpha\},$$
$$\text{CVar}_\alpha(L) = \frac{1}{1-\alpha} \int_\alpha^1 \text{VaR}_u(L) du = \mathbb{E}[L \mid L \geq \text{VaR}_\alpha(L)].$$

Rockafellar-Uryasew Dual

$$\text{CVar}_\alpha(L) = \inf\left\{ \nu \mid \frac{1}{1-\alpha} \mathbb{E}[L - \nu] \right\}$$

$$(L - \nu)^+ = \max(L - \nu, 0)$$

Entropic Risk

$$\rho_\lambda(X) = \frac{1}{\lambda} \log \mathbb{E}[\exp(-\lambda X)], \quad \lambda > 0$$

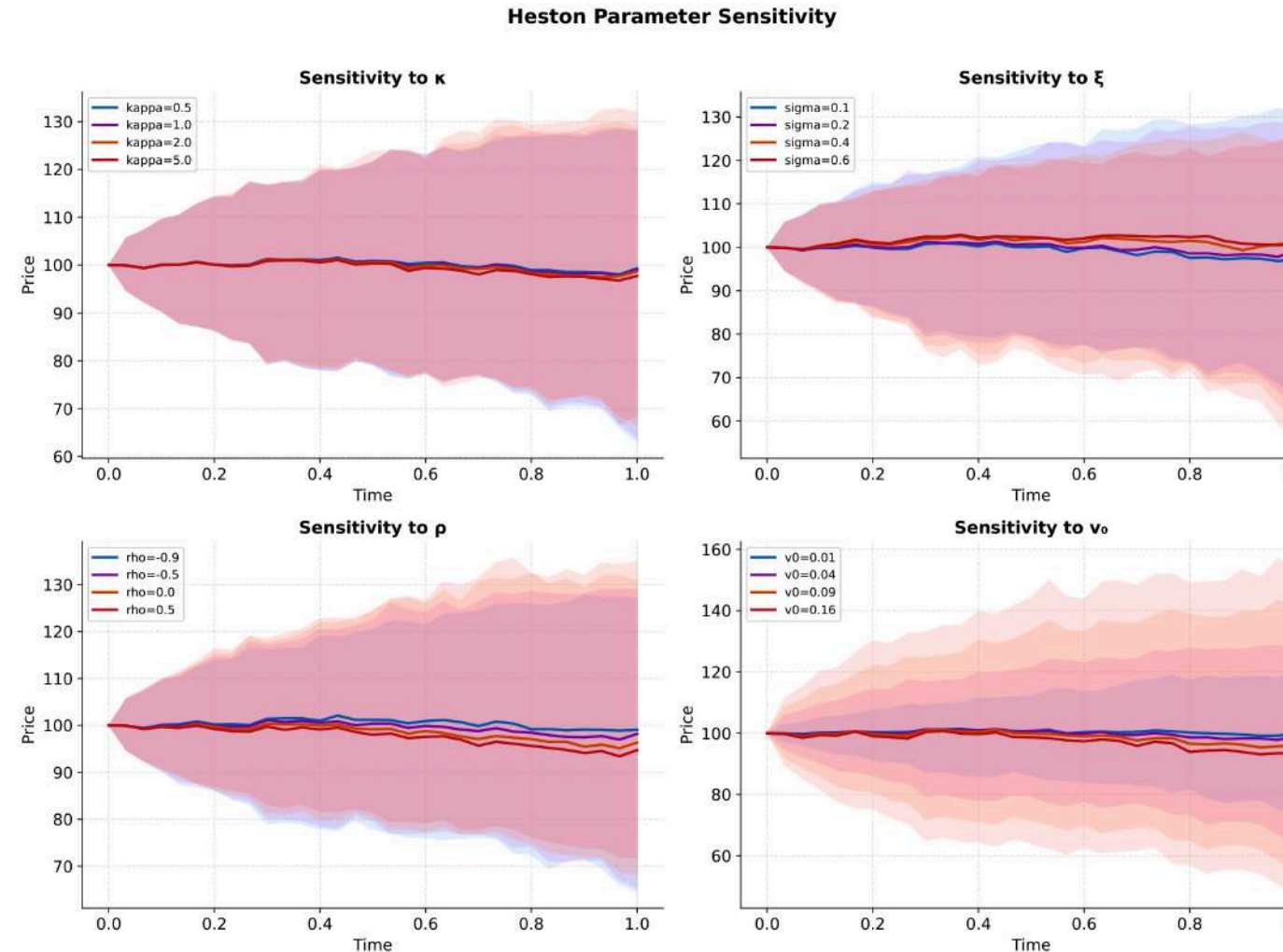
$$\rho_\lambda(X) = \sup_{Q \ll P} \left\{ \mathbb{E}_Q[-X] - \frac{1}{\lambda} \text{KL}(Q \parallel P) \right\}$$

Distributionally Robust Risk

$$\rho_\delta^P(X) = \sup_{Q \in \mathcal{Q}(P, \delta)} \mathbb{E}_Q[-X]$$

$$D = \text{KL} \Rightarrow \text{Entropic risk}$$

$$D = W_1 \Rightarrow \text{Wasserstein DRO}$$



Neural Policy & Feature Engineering

$$\theta^* = \arg \min_{\theta} \rho(-P\&L(\theta^*)) \text{ with } \delta_k = \delta_{\max} \cdot \tanh(F_{\theta}(I_{0:k}, \delta_{k-1})), \delta_{\max} = 1.5.$$

$I_k = (S_k/S_0, \log(S_k/K), \sqrt{v_k}, \tau_k, \Delta_k^{\text{BS}}) \in \mathbb{R}^5$ where $\tau_k = (T - t_k)/T$ is normalised time-to-maturity and Δ_k^{BS} is Black-Scholes delta.

4. Experimental Setup

Heston Parameters

$S_0 = K = 100$, $v_0 = 0.04$, $\kappa = 1.0$, $\theta_v = 0.04$, $\xi = 0.2$, $\rho = -0.7$, $r = 0.05$, $T = 30/365$, $N = 30$.

Data & Training

- **80,000** Heston paths: **50K train / 10K val / 20K test**

Identical two-stage (CVar → Entropic) protocol for all models:

- **Stage 1**: 50 epochs, $L_1 = \text{CVar}_{0.95}(-P\&L)$, lr = 10^{-3} , patience 15
- **Stage 2**: 30 epochs, $L_2 = \rho_\lambda(-P\&L) + \gamma \sum_k |\Delta \delta_k|$, lr = 10^{-4} , patience 10
- Adam optimizer, weight decay 10^{-4} , gradient clipping $\|\nabla\| \leq 5.0$, batch size 256

Novel model-specific additions operate *within* this protocol: W-DRO-T adds DRO penalty only in Stage 2; 3SCH splits 80 epochs as 40+15+25; RSE pre-trains base models then trains gating.

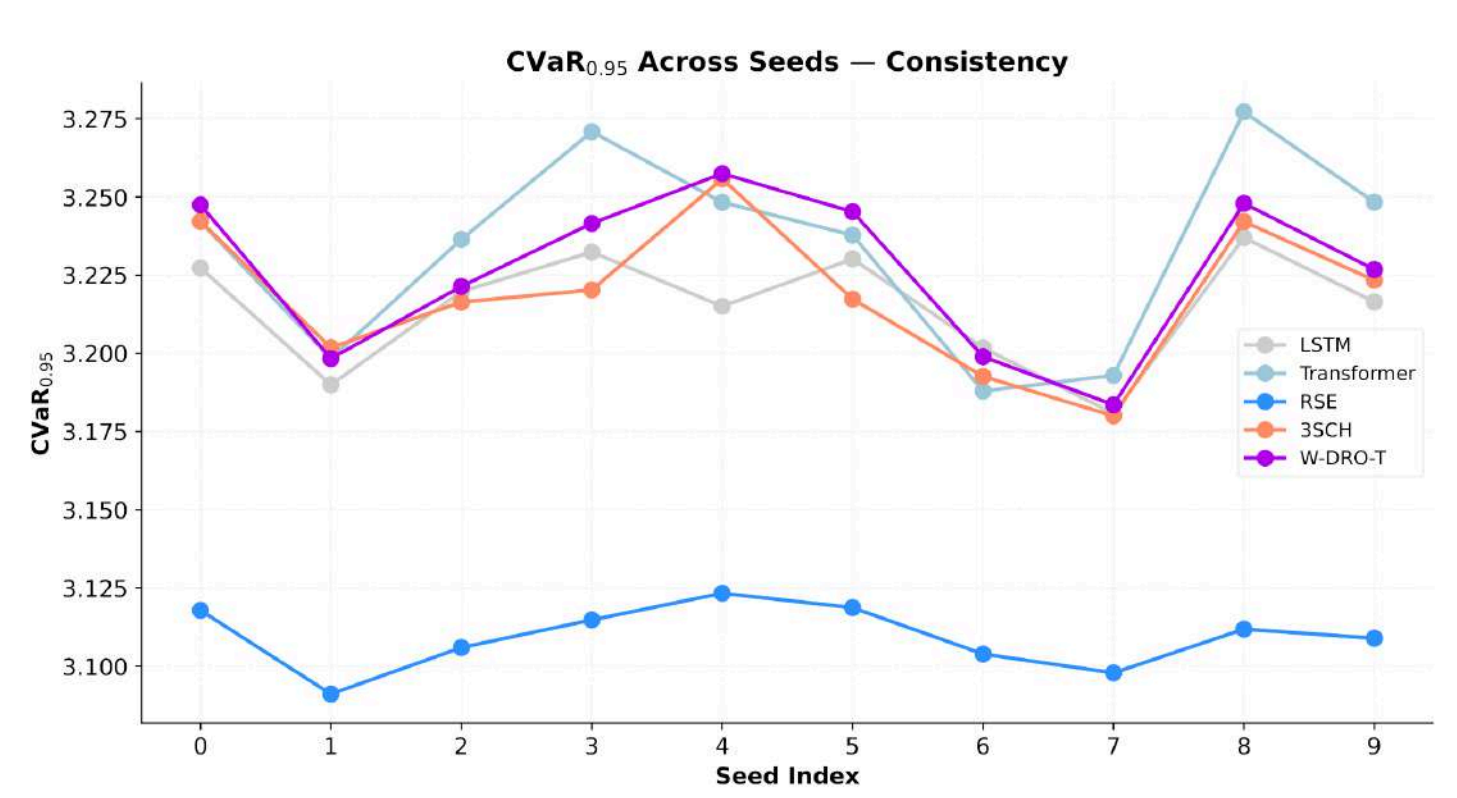
Statistical Methodology

- 10 independent seeds (42, 142, ..., 942)
- 10,000 bootstrap resamples for 95% CIs
- Paired t-tests with Holm-Bonferroni correction
- Cohen's d effect sizes for practical significance

Model Comparison & Computational Aspects

Table 18: Computational requirements per model.

Model	Params	Time/seed	GPU RAM	Total (10 seeds)
LSTM	54K	273s	1.2 GB	46 min
3SCH	54K	295s	1.2 GB	49 min
RSE	~200K	924s	2.1 GB	154 min
W-DRO-T	85K	7,119s	3.8 GB	1,187 min
Transformer	85K	7,534s	3.2 GB	1,256 min



5. Research Contributions

Three novel approaches addressing **fundamental gaps in deep hedging**, evaluated rigorously across 10 seeds with bootstrap CIs and Holm-Bonferroni corrected tests.

W-DRO-T: Wasserstein DRO Transformer

- **Gap addressed**: standard deep hedging optimizes expected risk under the training distribution P , which fails under crisis-driven distributional shifts.
- **Distributionally robust objective**

$$\theta^* = \arg \min_{\theta} \sup_{Q: W_1(Q, P) \leq \epsilon} \mathbb{E}_Q[\rho(P\&L(\delta_{\theta}))]$$

Dual reformulation

$$\sup_{Q: W_1(Q, P) \leq \epsilon} \mathbb{E}_Q[\ell(X)] = \inf_{\lambda \geq 0} \{\lambda \epsilon + \mathbb{E}_P[\ell^*(\lambda; X)]\}$$

$$\ell^*(\lambda; X) = \sup_{\theta} \{\ell(\theta') - \lambda \|\theta - \theta'\|\}$$

Gradient-penalty approximation

$$L_{\text{DRO}}(\theta) = \mathbb{E}_P[\ell(\theta; X)] + \epsilon \mathbb{E}_P[\|\nabla_{\theta} \ell(\theta; X)\|_2]$$

$$\nabla_{\theta} \|\nabla_{\theta} \ell(\theta; X)\|_2$$

Second-order gradient

computed using `create_graph=True`.

- **Backend constraint**: Flash/Efficient attention unsupported → **SDPA MATH** backend used during training.

- **Result**: 46% CVar₉₅ improvement during DRO regimes and 41% Basel III/IV capital reduction.

3SCH: Three-Stage Curriculum Hedger

- **Gap**: abrupt CVar₉₅ → entropic objective transition.
- **Mixed loss**

$$L_{\text{mix}}(\alpha; \theta) = \alpha \text{CVar}_{0.95}(-P\&L_{\theta}) + (1 - \alpha) \rho_{\lambda}(-P\&L_{\theta})$$

$$\alpha(t) = 0.8 - 0.6 \frac{t}{T_2 - 1}$$

Trading penalty

$$\gamma \sum_{k=0}^{N-1} |\delta_k - \delta_{k-1}|$$

Band regularisation

$$\nu \sum_k \max(0, |\delta_k - \delta_k^{\text{ref}}| - \epsilon)$$

- **Result**: best NIFTY CVar₉₅ = 622.26 with minimal trading volume.

RSE: Regime-Switching Ensemble

- **Gap**: single models fail across heterogeneous regimes.
- **Ensemble variance reduction**

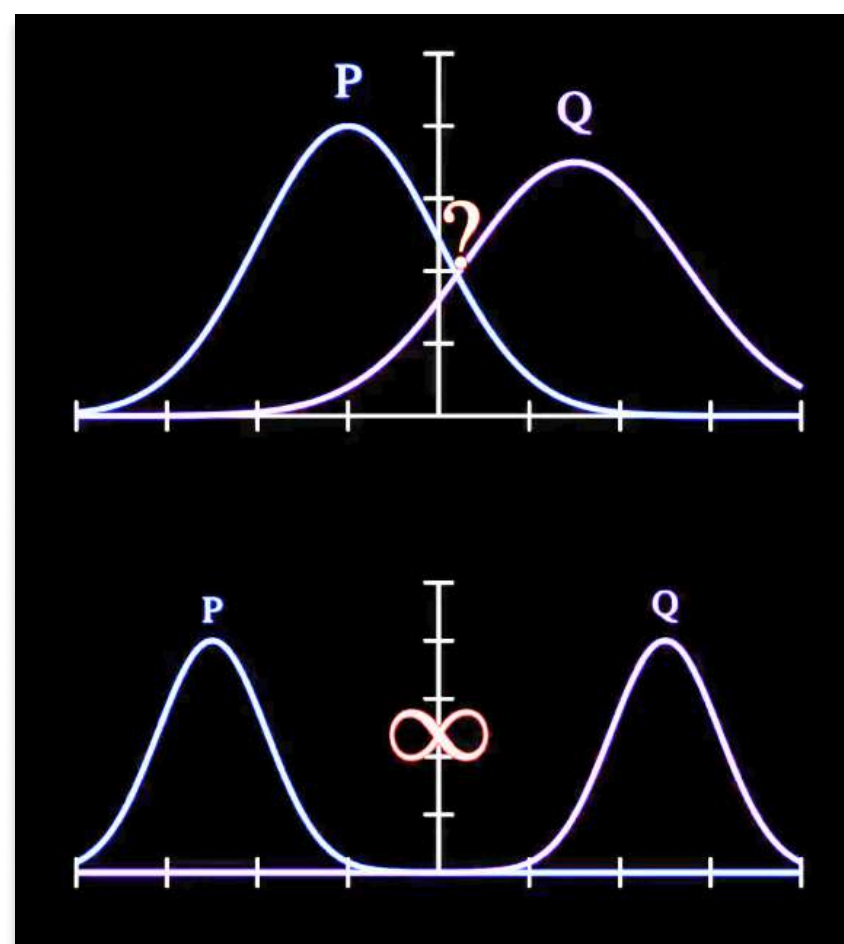
$$\text{Var}(f) = \frac{\sigma^2}{M} + \frac{M-1}{M} \bar{\rho} \sigma^2$$

$$\delta_k^{\text{RSE}} = \sum_{m=1}^M w_m(r_k) \delta_k^{(m)}$$

$$p(r_k = j | I_{0:k}) = \text{softmax}(f_{\theta}(r_k))$$

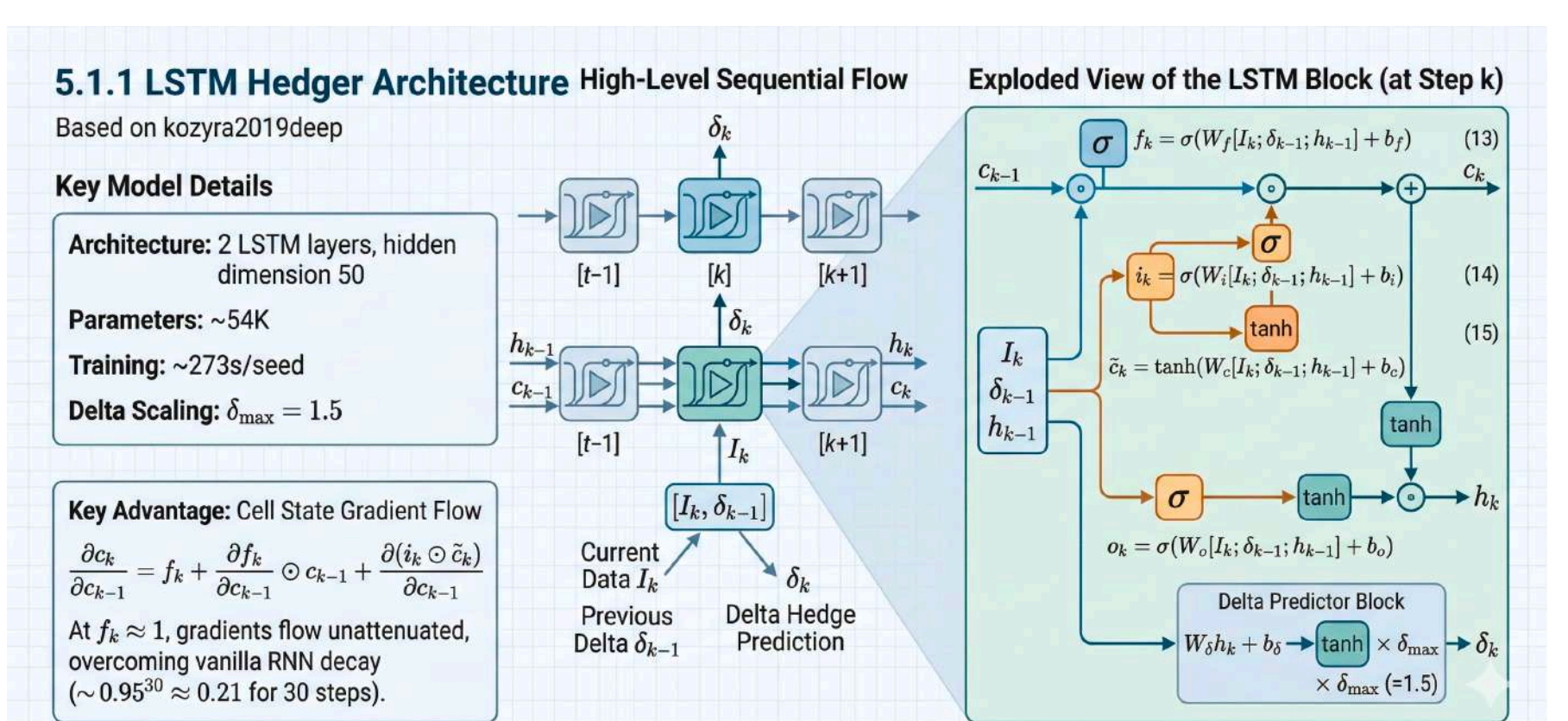
$$w_m(r_k) = \sum_{j=1}^K p(r_k = j) [\text{softmax}(A_j/r_j)]_m$$

- **Result**: CVar₉₅ = 3.109 ± 0.010, -3.29% vs LSTM ($p < 0.0001$).

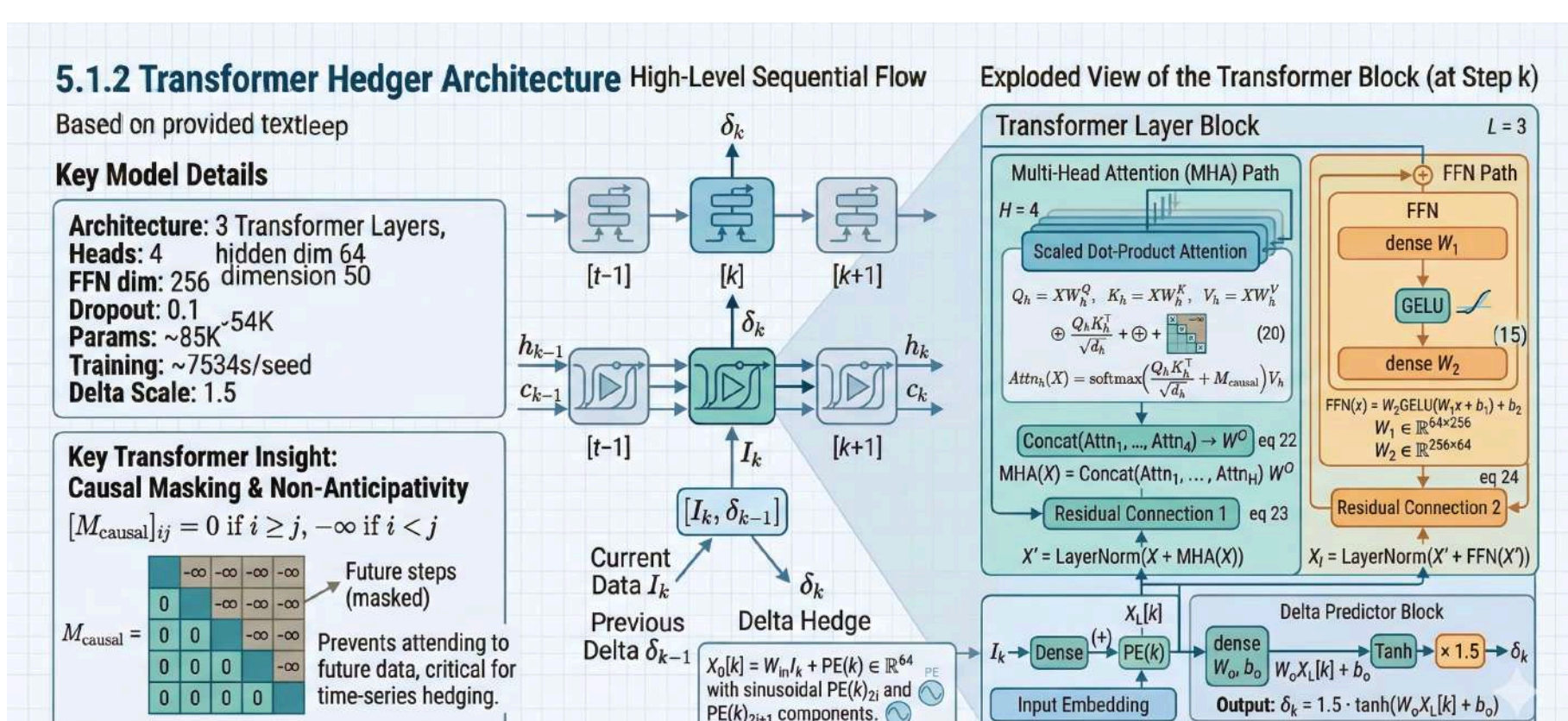


6. Hedging Architectures & Ablation Studies

LSTM Hedger



Transformer Hedger



RSE Architecture

Regime Feature Extraction

We extract six regime-relevant features from the price path.

Definition (Regime Feature Vector). At time step k , the regime feature vector is

$$r_k = (RV_k^{(1)}, RV_k^{(2)}, RV_k^{(3)}, \text{Trend}_k, \text{Momentum}_k, \text{Jump}_k)$$

Realized Volatility. For window $w \in \{5, 10, 20\}$

$$RV_k^{(w)} = \sqrt{\frac{1}{w} \sum_{s=k-w+1}^k (\log S_s - \log S_{s-1})^2}$$

Trend Indicator (SMA crossover).

$$\text{Trend}_k = \frac{SMA_5(S_k) - SMA_{20}(S_k)}{SMA_{20}(S_k)}$$

Momentum.

$$\text{Momentum}_k = \frac{S_k - S_{k-5}}{S_{k-5}}$$

Jump Indicator (Barndorff-Nielsen Ratio).

$$\text{Jump}_k = \frac{RV_k^{(20)}}{RV_k^{(5)}}$$

where the bipower variation is

$$BV_k^{(w)} = \frac{w}{2} \sum_{s=k-w+1}^k |r_s| |r_{s+1}|$$

and $\text{Jump}_k > 1$ indicates the presence of jump activity.

Learned Affinity Matrix

Table 2: Learned affinity (typical run, after softmax).

Regime	LSTM	Transformer	Signature
Low vol (calm)	0.52	0.28	0.20
High vol (stress)	0.18	0.54	0.28
Trending	0.31	0.41	0.28
Mean-reverting	0.45	0.22	0.33

Table 4: Ablation: number of regimes K

K	CVar ₉₅	Note
2	3.128	Under-specified
3	3.115	Competitive
4 (default)	3.109	Best
6	3.112	Diminishing returns

7. Experimental Results

Main Performance (10 Seeds, 20K Test Paths)

Table 7: Test set performance (mean ± std, 10 seeds, 50K training paths). Lower is better for all metrics except trading volume.

Model	CVar ₉₅	Std P&L	Entropic	Trade Vol	Mean P&L	CV%
RSE	3.109 ± 0.010*	0.456	2.376	1.379	-2.277	0.30
LSTM	3.215 ± 0.018	0.440	2.379	1.187	-2.278	0.55
3SCH	3.219 ± 0.022	0.453	2.381	1.122	-2.277	0.69
W-DRO-T	3.227 ± 0.024	0.450	2.380	1.119	-2.277	0.75
Transformer	3.234 ± 0.030	0.450	2.380	1.117	-2.277	0.92

* $p < 0.0001$ vs LSTM after Holm-Bonferroni correction.

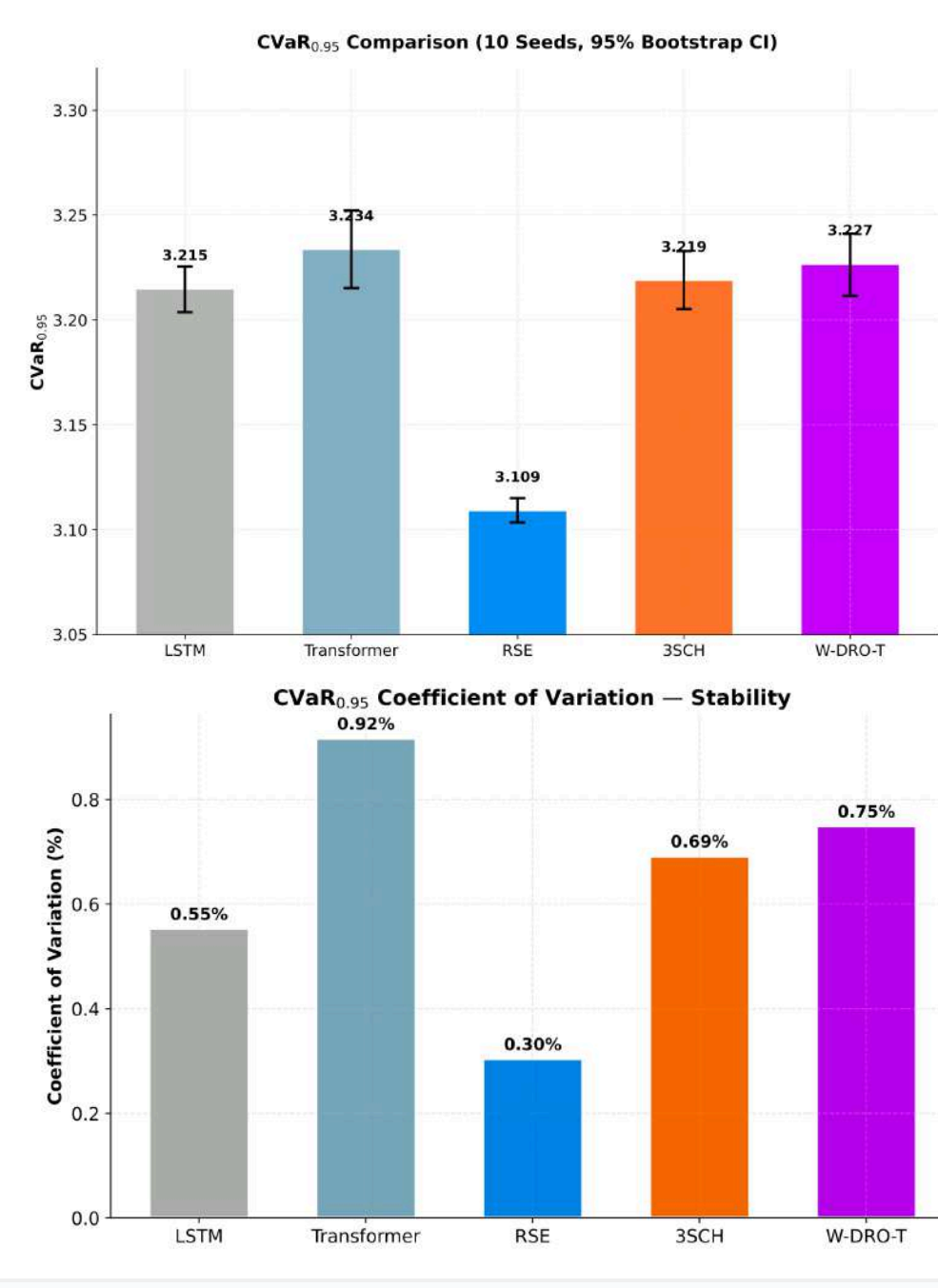
Paired Comparison vs LSTM

Table 8: Paired comparison vs. LSTM (Holm-Bonferroni corrected).

Model	$\Delta\%$	p -value	Cohen's d	Effect
RSE	-3.29	< 0.0001	-7.41	Very Large
3SCH	+0.13	0.438	+0.20	Small
W-DRO-T	+0.37	0.016	+0.56	Medium
Transformer	+0.59	0.006	+0.93	Large

Key Findings

- **RSE: Best tail risk, lowest CV** — ensemble stability confirmed
- **RSE's 95% CI [3.103, 3.115] non-overlapping** with all others
- **DRO does not degrade in-distribution** ($p=0.188$ vs Transformer)
- **3SCH preserves baseline performance** ($p=0.438$ vs LSTM)
- All models: **Mean P&L ≈ -2.277**, confirming negligible bias



8. Real Market Validation

- **SPY** (3 bps cost, 2 bps slippage): Normal ($\sigma = 15\%$), Post-COVID (20%), COVID (65%), 2008 (80%)
- **NIFTY** (18 bps cost, 5 bps slippage): Normal (14%), COVID (55%), 2008 (70%)

SPY — US Market (3 bps cost)

Table 10: CVar₉₅ across SPY scenarios (5,000 paths, 18 bps cost).

Model	Normal	Post-COVID	COVID	GFC 2008
LSTM	20.28	27.36	86.84	100.88
Transformer	14.47	19.66	64.80	72.71
RSE	16.90	23.20	69.76	84.57
W-DRO-T	11.98	20.69	46.94	62.26
3SCH	15.79	21.43	69.25	88.43

W-DRO-T dominates all US scenarios: 41% improvement over LSTM in normal, 46% in COVID, 38% in GFC 2008.

The DRO gradient penalty provides measurable distributional robustness precisely when **capital is most constrained**.

NIFTY 50 — Indian Market (18 bps cost)

Table 11: CVar₉₅ across NIFTY scenarios (5,000 paths, 18 bps cost).

Model	Normal	COVID	GFC 2008
LSTM	785.62	3028.93	3645.62
Transformer	709.61	1644.19	2853.31
RSE	686.62	2592.97	2841.25
W-DRO-T	663.92	2883.96	2349.72
3SCH	622.26	2465.71	2963.35

3SCH optimal for NIFTY normal (622.26) — lowest trading volume (0.90) minimizes 18 bps costs. Transformer dominates COVID (1644.19).

The **higher NIFTY costs penalise** W-DRO-T's active trading. 3SCH's advantage stems from trading volume: 0.90 vs W-DRO-T 2.70 and Transformer 2.09. At 18 bps, each trade costs 6× more than SPY.

Crisis Robustness (COVID/Normal Ratio)

Table 12: Crisis-to-normal CVar₉₅ ratio (SPY; lower = more robust).

Model	COVID/Normal	2008/Normal	Interpretation
W-DRO-T	3.92×	3.20×	Best COVID robustness
RSE	4.13×	5.00×	Moderate
LSTM	4.28×	4.97×	Baseline
3SCH	4.30×	5.60×	Moderate
Transformer	4.48×	5.02×	High degradation

